

SlyControl brings the comfort and convenience offered by the Media Center PC to your computer

Jayesh Limaye

The comfort and convenience offered by the Windows XP Media Center PC is worth drooling over—all you need is the remote, and you can do almost whatever you want!

A remote is a good thing. And if the Media Center PC is not something you're keen on buying, there's an alternative way to control PC applications using a remote—your TV tuner's remote control, to be precise.

You can get the SlyDiman's SlyControl software at <http://snipurl.com/ez29>. It allows you to run and remotely control any Windows application, such as Winamp, PVR software, FM Radio, Windows Media Player, and much more.

You can also remotely log off, reboot or shutdown the system. SlyControl achieves this by using the remote from a TV tuner card package, or through other devices such as joysticks.

SlyControl supports several devices including IR remote controls of TV tuners using the BT8x8 and Philips chips, the Creative Live! Drive, the ATi Remote Wonder, the Generic DCD (LIRC) and Serial (UIR/Irman) devices, WinLIRC, uICE, and also through a sound

card by plugging the IR photo module to the line-in jack.

Here, we will only talk about using SlyControl in conjunction with your TV tuner's remote—whatever brand you may have, SlyControl will probably work with it. The software costs \$26.89 (approximately Rs 1,170).

1 STEP When you start SlyControl, the configuration window opens. Here, you are presented with a multitude of remote control plugins to choose from.

Select the appropriate plugin that corresponds to the TV

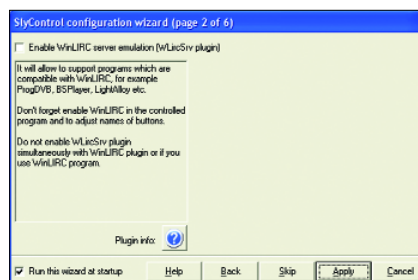


Choose the right corresponding remote control plugin

remote installed on your system. If you click the 'Setup' button at the top of this window, you can view the remote control button assignments. Click 'Apply'.

2 STEP In this step, you can enable WinLIRC server emulation by simply clicking 'Apply'.

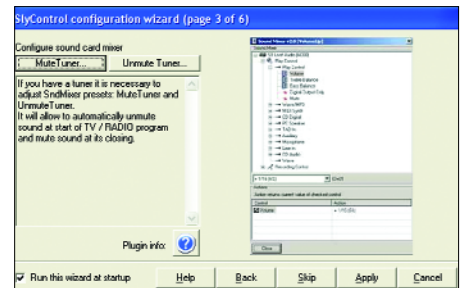
Also, you might want to



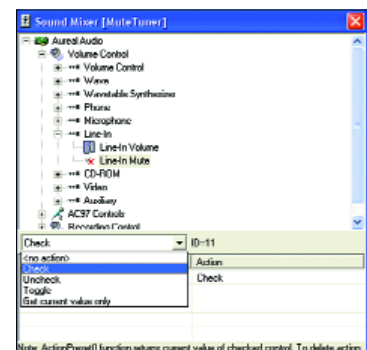
Enable WinLIRC server emulation

enable WinLIRC server emulation in case you have programmes such as ProgDVB, BSPlayer and LightAlloy. These programmes are supported by WinLIRC, and can be supported in SlyControl if you use WinLIRC emulation.

3 STEP Now, let's configure your sound card mixer. You can set up the sound to automatically un-mute



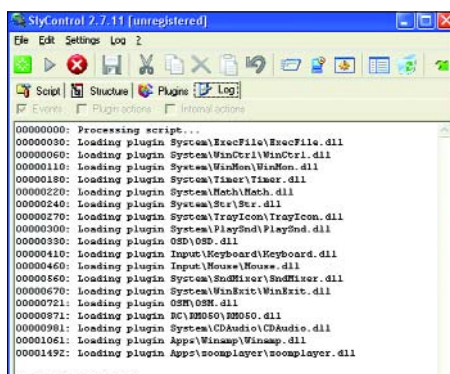
Configuring the sound card mixer



Set default action for 'Mute' function

at the start of a TV or radio programme, and mute when it's over (applicable only if you are using a TV tuner remote control, and not the other devices that we have mentioned).

Click the 'Mute Tuner' and then the 'Unmute Tuner' buttons in order to adjust these settings. Click 'Apply' to proceed.



SlyControl up and running



for technology knowledge

To get speedy access to the best source of knowledge and insight in technology, fast forward to www.zdnetindia.com